

Pregnancy & Return-to-Play Pathway

Ten-stage pathway · WSL 26-week · FIFA Art. 18quater notes

Document ref	OWFC-MED-009	Version	1.3
Effective	01 Feb 2026	Next review	01 Feb 2027
Owner	Club Doctor	Classification	Internal — Controlled

1. Principle

Pregnancy is treated as a phase of a player’s career the club has a duty to support, not a risk to monitor. The pathway is player-led at every stage.

2. Ten stages

Notification & confirmation → clinical handover → adapted training (T1, T2) → cessation of contact → maternity leave → postpartum medical clearance → pelvic-floor & MSK screening → graduated RTP (non-contact → contact) → match selection cleared.

3. Policy backstop

WSL 26 weeks full pay (UK domestic minimum); FIFA Regulations Art. 18quater — 14 weeks paid maternity globally (8 weeks post-birth minimum, anti-termination, mandatory reintegration). Whichever is more favourable applies. Clinical detail stays with the player and Club Doctor; the Director and Coach see availability status only.

Approval & sign-off

Name	Role	Signed	Date
Dr Anna Reid	Club Doctor	<i>signed</i>	01 Feb 2026
Nina Walsh	Welfare Lead	<i>signed</i>	01 Feb 2026